

A Question of Copyright

Writers all over the world look for inspiration from fellow writers and at times they do find a certain bit of information interesting and it very easily gets included in their own work. But nothing irks more than when someone tries to take the credit for your hard work and tries to pass it off as theirs! The Net is a place where such things go largely unnoticed, as it is near impossible to keep track of who is using your information and how they're using it.

Companies and other institutional bodies worry about copyright infringement due to content theft. It is but natural then, that they feel insecure about losing their content to hungry prowlers. So what's the remedy?

Enter Digital Rights Management (DRM). Similar to digital water marking technology that helps to identify your prized documents, DRM is basically a server-side software that helps to keep track of your information online. This technology makes it virtually impossible to steal information from Web pages. The software has multi-level administration rights and is useful for safeguarding your content. The software uses advanced encryption parameters such that it doesn't allow individuals to copy and paste documentations, or even photographs from Web pages. Aside from this, it lets visitors to the site view and print certain information only for a certain amount of time. To view the content, you have to download plugins. Once protected, images or text cannot be copied, saved, printed or screen captured.

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	Paper book	eBook
Format	Paper	Electronic
Weight	Depends on the edition	Light and easily portable
Updates	Buy a new one	Update via the Net
Features	Excellent photo quality	Depends upon the technology used
Cost factor	Expensive	Rather expensive at the moment
Reach	Universal	Catching on
Works on	-	Battery

All you have to do now is log on to the Net and put up your precious work in the form of an eBook on any one of the sites that allow you to publish your own eBook for free.

While you can start off with creating an eBook in text format or Rich Text Format (the two formats that are by and large universally accepted), this won't add the much needed functionality and readability to your eBook.

eBooks make for engrossing reading only when you add interactive elements such as book-marks (chapter divisions), hyperlinks, tags, etc, that allow for a smoother navigation and more functionality.

Are the gizmos ready for use?

Excited about the prospects presented by eBooks? Well, hold your horses—here comes the bad news. Owing to the fact that eBooks are a relatively new medium, entrepreneurs are seeking to cash in on it as a business opportunity.

Of late, the market has seen the entry of quite a few eBook readers and devices such as PDAs and handhelds.

However, an accompanying problem is the fact that some of these devices are dedicated devices, which means that they support any one particular format.

A handheld device, such as the Palm or the Pocket PC that can read multiple formats will therefore be preferred over these dedicated devices that read only one format.

A few other technical setbacks with handheld devices include a small viewing area and also problems with the display of text and graphical images, which are in low resolution and are pixelated. As a result, eyestrain is a major complaint that people have with eBook devices, or with reading eBooks

Creating your eBook

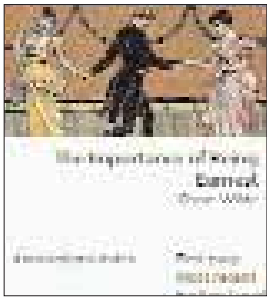
Once you've written your eBook, you then need to convert it to an e-format that can be read on the screen of your computer or handheld device.

Using MS Reader: When you download the MS Reader software and plugins (from www.microsoft.com/reader), an icon called 'Read' is installed on the main tool bar. Open the text in MS Word and choose the Read option from the File Menu to convert the document to MS Word format. Just follow the

onscreen instructions to complete the process.

This converts your file into .lit format, which can be read on a handheld device such as the MS Book Reader.

The software is very user friendly, and helps you to bookmark, change font or highlight from the options menu.



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Using the Adobe eBook Reader

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